



6/1/2026

Addendum No.10

Solicitation Number: RFP 061726

Solicitation Name: Enterprise Artificial Intelligence: Platforms, Services, and Integrated Delivery

Consider the following Question(s) and Answer(s) to be part of the above-titled solicitation documents. The remainder of the documents remain unchanged.

Question 1:

We have extensive experience in FinTech (e.g., BBVA, Santander) and Logistics (e.g., FedEx). Does Sourcewell definitively classify the Logistics and Retail/E-commerce (e.g., Cencosud) sectors as highly regulated for the purposes of the responsiveness review?

Answer 1:

Refer to RFP Section VI. A. Responsiveness Criteria, as well as the thresholds and requirements listed in the RFP Questionnaire under the section titled, Responsiveness Criteria. Both areas provide a definition of highly regulated industries and examples of qualifying highly regulated industries.

Question 2:

What are the five most requested AI platform use cases among Sourcewell participating entities today? Are there 'must-have' capabilities evaluators expect to see addressed?

Answer 2:

In the competitive process, Sourcewell will not advise a proposer on the content of the proposal. It is left to the discretion of each proposer to determine how to best satisfy all requirements of the questionnaire tables.

Question 3:

What proportion of participating entities have deployed AI in production vs. those still in exploratory/pilot phases?

Answer 3:

Sourcewell is requesting proposals to meet the various needs of its 50,000+ Participating Entities as a whole, across the United States and Canada. In this competitive solicitation process, Sourcewell will not advise a proposer on the contents of its proposal. It is left to the discretion of each proposer to articulate and propose the solutions that aligns with its business methods and satisfies the requirements of the RFP. A Participating Entities' unique needs will be determined if and when the Participating Entities choose to utilize a contract resulting from this solicitation.

Question 4:

Is there a supplier marketplace or discovery portal where participating entities can browse and compare offerings from different MA awardees?

Answer 4:

Refer to Answer 3 above.

Question 5:

To ensure our proposal is as accurate and consistent as possible, we would greatly appreciate clarification on a few terminology. Specifically, could you please provide the definitions or the definitions exhibit for capitalized terms such as 'Program' or 'Delivery', which seem to hold specific meaning for this scope of engagement?

Answer 5:

Refer to Answer 2 above.

Question 6:

As per our understanding from the Master Agreement, Suppliers can propose redlines to identify any exception or request any modifications. Please confirm if it is acceptable to Sourcewell if we redline the Master Agreement document or the expectation would be to share these modifications in tabular format, we will accordingly prepare the list.

Answer 6:

Proposed exception requests or modifications are to be redlined in the Word version of the Master Agreement.

Question 7:

Our organization provides utility-focused consulting, system integration, managed services, modernization programs, and AI-enabled solutions for customer service, workforce productivity, workflow automation, knowledge management, and operational support across North America.

Given the broad nature of Lot 3 and the rolling supplier onboarding model described in the RFP, would Sourcewell encourage organizations with strong alignment to the integrated delivery model to submit a response in the current cycle if their primary objective is to establish participation and visibility within the contract vehicle while continuing to mature and expand their AI offerings and commercialization approach?

Alternatively, would Sourcewell recommend waiting for a future supplier onboarding opportunity once those offerings are more fully developed?

Any guidance on how Sourcewell views organizations in this position would be appreciated as we evaluate the most appropriate participation strategy.

Answer 7:

In the competitive process, Sourcewell will not advise a proposer on the content of the proposal. Sourcewell will not pre-qualify any products or services. It is left to the discretion of each Proposer to determine if its products or services meet the scope of RFP II. B. Requested Equipment, Products, or Services. Only those products within the scope of the RFP will be included in any contract awarded by Sourcewell as a result of the solicitation.

Question 8:

The RFP Questionnaire requests the Proposer's CAGE code or Unique Entity Identifier (SAM), which are typically required for entities doing business with the U.S. federal government. Can Sourcewell clarify how Canadian suppliers (or other non-U.S. entities) that do not have a CAGE code or SAM registration should respond to this requirement, and whether an alternative identifier or "N/A" response is acceptable?

Answer 8:

A CAGE or Unique Entity Identifier (SAM) code is not required to be considered for or awarded a Sourcewell contract. Proposals are evaluated based on the criteria as stated in the RFP.

Question 9:

Since Pricing now represents 25% of the total score, will Sourcewell prioritize high-volume not-to-exceed hourly rates for professional services, or is there a preference for Outcome-based pricing models for AI implementations?

Answer 9:

Each supplier will propose pricing in the format that makes sense for their industry. Each proposer, in its discretion, will determine and articulate the pricing approach that aligns with its business methods and satisfies all the requirements of the III. Pricing section of the RFP. Proposals are evaluated based on the criteria stated in the RFP.

Question 10:

Regarding the Depth and Breadth of Offered Solutions, does Sourcewell value the number of different AI technologies mastered more than the number of specific AI products offered?

Answer 10:

Refer to Answer 2 above.

Question 11:

Does the definition of 'standalone AI platform' exclude platforms that also include BI reporting, process automation, or non-AI modules? Where is the boundary between a qualifying AI platform and an ERP/CRM with AI features?

Answer 11:

Sourcewell will not pre-qualify any products or services. It is left to the discretion of each Proposer to determine if its products or services meet the scope of RFP II. B. Requested Equipment, Products, or Services. Only those products within the scope of the RFP will be included in any contract awarded by Sourcewell as a result of the solicitation.

Question 12:

For the AI Maturity Assessment requirement in Lot 2, would Sourcewell accept a proprietary tool like our Modernization Health Check Scorecard as a valid methodology for evaluating a Participating Entity's readiness?

Answer 12:

See Answer 11 above.

Question 13:

Since the Master Agreement term is a non-extendable 10 years, how frequently can proposers update their Rate Card or Line-Item Pricing to account for the rapid evolution and potential cost changes of AI technologies over a decade?

Answer 13:

Refer to the Sourcewell Master Agreement, Article II: Sourcewell and Supplier Obligations, B. Product and Price Changes.

Question 14:

Will Sourcewell provide a specific template for the Pricing Narrative to ensure all proposers explain their total cost of ownership (TCO) calculations in a consistent format?

Answer 14:

A specific format is not required for submission, but Excel is preferred. Each supplier will propose pricing in the format that makes sense for their industry. Each proposer, in its discretion, will determine and articulate the pricing approach that aligns with its business methods and satisfies all the requirements of the **III. Pricing section of the RFP**. Proposals are evaluated based on the criteria stated in the RFP.

Question 15:

Does Sourcewell provide awarded suppliers with contact information for participating entities, curated lead lists, or direct introductions?

Answer 15:

Awarded suppliers will work with their Supplier Development Executive to best market the contract post-award.

Question 16:

What level of Explainable AI (XAI) do participating entities typically expect — required for all use cases, or only for high-stakes decisions such as benefits eligibility or criminal justice?

Answer 16:

Sourcewell utilizes a competitive, solutions-based solicitation approach that is NOT based on detailed specifications or specific opportunities. A proposer can propose its entire offering that falls within the requested equipment, products, or services as described in II. Solicitation Details. B. Requested Equipment, Products, or Services within the RFP.

Question 17:

Are the 175 points for Responsible AI evaluated on corporate AI ethics policies, or on specific technical features of the offered solution (explainability, bias detection, auditability)?

Answer 17:

See Answer 2 above.

Question 18:

Is there a specific Responsible AI framework that Sourcewell or its participating entities expect awarded suppliers to adopt (NIST AI RMF, ISO 42001, a federal Executive Order requirement)?

Answer 18:

See Answer 11 above.

Question 19:

Does the evaluation process include oral presentations, product demonstrations, or proof-of-concept evaluations, or is the award decision based solely on the written proposal?

Answer 19:

Refer to Answer 2 above.

Sourcewell does not intend to allow proposer presentations at this time.

Question 20:

What is the profile of the proposal evaluators — Sourcewell procurement professionals, external AI SMEs, or participating entity representatives?

Answer 20:

In regard to this RFP, the proposal evaluation committee will be comprised of Sourcewell procurement professionals.

Question 21:

For 'Depth and Breadth of Offered Solutions' (200 pts — highest single evaluable weight after Pricing), does Sourcewell favor breadth across many use cases or depth in fewer specialized areas?

Answer 21:

Refer to Answer 2 above.

Question 22:

What are the contract termination provisions for services engagements? Can a participating entity terminate a SOW for convenience, and what is the minimum notice period?

Answer 22:

Refer to RFP Section I. B. – Use of Resulting Contracts, “Participating Entities typically access master agreements for equipment, products, or services through a purchase order issued directly to the awarded supplier. A Participating Entity may request additional terms or conditions related to a purchase.”

Question 23:

Do K-12 and higher education entities have materially different AI professional services needs vs. government agencies? Should the proposal address segments with differentiated service lines?

Answer 23:

Refer to Answer 2 above.

Question 24:

What proportion of participating entities have deployed AI in production vs. those still in exploratory/pilot phases?

Answer 24:

Refer to Answer 3 above.

Question 25:

Are there currently active Responsible AI governance initiatives within Sourcewell or its participating entities that awarded service providers would be expected to align with?

Answer 25:

Refer to Answer 3 above.

Question 26:

Does the definition of 'standalone AI platform' exclude platforms that also include BI reporting, process automation, or non-AI modules? Where is the boundary between a qualifying AI platform and an ERP/CRM with AI features?

Answer 26:

Refer to Answer 11 above.

Question 27:

What AI Professional Services are most in demand among participating entities today — strategy/governance, platform implementation, or managed services? Where is current supply insufficient?

Answer 27:

Refer to Answer 3 above.

Question 28:

Do AI Security Operations services under Lot 2 need to include adversarial red-teaming against clients' deployed models, or is the scope limited to ongoing production monitoring?

Answer 28:

Refer to Answer 11 above.

Question 29:

Does 'AI Software Development & Engineering' under Lot 2 include foundational model fine-tuning and custom model training, or only applications consuming existing third-party models via API?

Answer 29:

Refer to Answer 11 above.

Question 30:

How does Sourcewell handle product updates and new offerings during the MA term? Can we add new platform versions without a new solicitation?

Answer 30:

Refer to Answer 13 above.

Question 31:

Does the Master Agreement require fixed not-to-exceed prices for the full 10-year term, or are annual adjustments permitted (e.g., tied to CPI or a technology price index)?

Answer 31:

Refer to Answer 13 above.

Question 32:

Lot 2 Demonstrated Experience qualification — value, timing, and AI scope. For the Lot 2 Demonstrated Experience requirement of approximately \$200,000 with a qualifying highly regulated industry client, active within the 12 months preceding the proposal submission deadline, (a) where the qualifying engagement spans a duration longer than the 12-month lookback window, is the ~\$200,000 minimum measured against total engagement contract value, value of work performed or invoiced within the 12-month lookback window, or remaining contract value as of the submission date; (b) does “active within the 12 months preceding the proposal submission deadline” require the engagement to be active at any point within that 12-month window, active at the submission date itself, or both signed and performed entirely within the 12-month window; and (c) must AI services constitute the primary deliverable of the engagement, or does the engagement qualify if AI services represent a meaningful and discretely identifiable component of a broader services engagement (e.g., a cloud modernization or data engineering engagement that included AI-enabled deliverables)?

Responsible AI scoring for third-party foundation models. For the Responsible AI and Governance evaluation category, how will Sourcewell weigh a proposer’s reliance on a third-party foundation model provider (e.g., a commercial LLM provider with a published Responsible Scaling Policy and Usage Policy) versus a proposer’s own internally documented governance practices? Are documented operationalizations of an underlying model provider’s published policies (such as the provider’s Responsible Scaling Policy, Usage Policy, or safety evaluations) treated as supplier-controlled evidence, third-party evidence, or both, and does that affect scoring?

Answer 32:

Refer to Answer 11 above.

Question 33:

Pricing mechanics over the 10-year Master Agreement term. (a) Across the 10-year Master Agreement term, does Sourcewell express a preference for a

particular price scaling methodology (e.g., CPI-linked adjustment, fixed annual cap, vendor-elected escalator schedule), or is the choice of scaling mechanism left entirely to the proposer to articulate in the Pricing Narrative? (b) For Lot 2 engagements that include consumption-based third-party costs (e.g., foundation model API usage, cloud hosting, vector database, observability tooling), may these costs be disclosed in the Pricing Sheet as cost-plus-fixed-markup line items or pass-through line items with a defined administrative fee, or must they be embedded inside a single composite services rate; and if pass-through is permitted, what disclosure format does Sourcewell expect (e.g., named third-party vendor, current published rate, markup percentage)?

Answer 33:

Refer to Answer 14 above.

Question 34:

Subcontractor handling for primary submissions and demonstrated experience. (a) May a proposer submit its own primary proposal under one Lot and also be identified as a subcontractor in another proposer's submission under the same Lot or a different Lot, and if permitted, are there any disclosure or coordination requirements that apply to either proposal? (b) Where a Lot 2 qualifying engagement cited for Demonstrated Experience was delivered with limited subcontractor support (for example, less than 25% of total engagement value), is the proposer required to itemize that subcontractor relationship in the experience narrative, or is disclosure only required where the subcontractor delivered a material or accountable portion of the work; if a threshold applies, what percentage or scope-based test does Sourcewell use?

Answer 34:

Per RFP Section II. D. Single Primary Lot, "Sourcewell prefers suppliers that provide a sole source of responsibility for the equipment, products, and services provided under a resulting master agreement. If proposer includes the equipment, products, and services of its subsidiary entities, the proposer must also identify all subsidiaries included in its proposal. If proposer requires the use of distributors, dealers, resellers, or subcontractors to provide the equipment, products, or services, the proposal must address how the equipment, products or services will be provided to Participating Entities, and describe the network of distributors, dealers, resellers, and/or subcontractors that will be available to serve Participating Entities under a resulting master agreement." Primary Lot selection is the proposer's determination and reflects how they primarily create value for Participating Entities.

A proposer may submit only one proposal. If related, affiliated, or subsidiary entities elect to submit separate proposals, rather than a single parent-entity proposal, each such proposal must be prepared independently and without cooperation, collaboration,

or collusion. It is left to the discretion of each proposer to determine the information or documentation necessary to best demonstrate their ability to serve Sourcewell Participating Entities and satisfy all the requirements of the RFP.

Question 35:

Reference confidentiality for Table 2B. Per Addendum 8 Q5, proposers must provide three references in Table 2B for evaluator and Participating Entity contact. Where a willing reference client cannot consent to public disclosure in the Sourcewell record due to internal confidentiality requirements or contractual constraints, may the proposer (a) submit the reference under a confidentiality designation, (b) provide redacted client identifiers with a verifiable equivalent (e.g., third-party attestation), or (c) substitute a different reference type, without the response being treated as non-conforming?

Answer 35:

Refer to RFP Section VI. E. Disposition of Proposals, which states, "Proposers are explicitly cautioned not to submit any data that they consider to be confidential, proprietary, or trade secret, as such data will not be treated as confidential and will be subject to public disclosure in accordance with Minnesota law."

Question 36:

Are there character or page limits per response cell, per table, or for the overall proposal? Are there limits on attachment file types and sizes?

Answer 36:

There is sufficient room to answer the question(s). The portal allows approximately 32,000 characters or 10-typed pages in each text field. Each answer should be clear and concise.

Question 37:

Is there a preferred level of quantified outcomes evaluators want to see (e.g., adoption rates, model accuracy, cost or cycle-time reduction)?

Answer 37:

Refer to Answer 2 above.

Question 38:

How many references are required, and may they be the same organizations cited in the Lot experience tab?

Answer 38:

Refer to Answer 2 above.

Question 39:

Will Sourcewell contact references during evaluation or only at award, and is there a preferred contact window?

Answer 39:

Refer to RFP Section VI. D. – Rights Reserved, “Sourcewell reserves the right to: Independently verify any information provided in a proposal.”

Question 40:

Must references be public-sector entities, or are regulated commercial references acceptable?

Answer 40:

Refer to instructions in Table 2B: References/Testimonials within the Questionnaire.

Question 41:

For the Authorized Sellers dealer-network questions, how should a services-led integrated provider that delivers directly (no reseller channel) respond to be scored fully? Will direct delivery be treated equivalently to a dealer network?

Answer 41:

Refer to Answer 2 above.

Question 42:

For the sales/service force questions, is there an expected minimum FTE threshold by sector (GOV/EDU), or are descriptive answers sufficient?

Answer 42:

Refer to Answer 2 above.

Question 43:

Are there common enterprise or government systems that Sourcewell entities most use (e.g., specific ERPs, ServiceNow, Workday, Microsoft 365) that we should explicitly address in the integration question?

Answer 43:

Refer to Answer 3 above.

Question 44:

What level of co-marketing support does Sourcewell provide, and are there brand/usage guidelines for referencing a Sourcewell-awarded agreement?

Answer 44:

The Sourcewell supplier development team provides support and resources to expand and enhance awarded supplier marketing efforts. In the competitive process, Sourcewell does not advise on the content of proposer marketing plans. Each proposal will be evaluated based on the criteria stated in the RFP.

Question 45:

Are marketing material samples scored, and is there a preferred format or quantity (e.g., one-pagers versus short slide decks)?

Answer 45:

Refer to RFP Section II. H. – Marketing Plan and Table 4: Marketing Plan within the Questionnaire for guidance on the marketing plan requirements. Each proposer, in its discretion, will determine the content of its marketing plan. The solicitation is a competitive process and proposals will be evaluated on the content submitted.

Question 46:

Is e-Procurement / e-Commerce punchout integration (with any specific platform) expected or scored for this category?

Answer 46:

Refer to Answer 2 above.

Question 47:

For Table 5B diversity, which certifications are recognized and weighted (e.g., MBE, WBE, SDVOSB, NMSDC, DBE), and are self-certifications accepted or must they be third-party issued?

Answer 47:

Proposers may describe any socioeconomic certifications their company or hub partners have attained in Table 5B, "Value-Added Attributes." Proposals are evaluated based on the criteria stated in the RFP.

Question 48:

For sustainability, are certifications expected to relate to AI/cloud operations (e.g., data-center energy efficiency or carbon), and how are they evaluated for a software- and services-based offering?

Answer 48:

Proposers may describe any sustainability certifications their company has attained in Table 5B, "Value-Added Attributes." Proposals are evaluated based on the criteria stated in the RFP.

Question 49:

What Administrative Fee percentage does Sourcewell typically expect for this category, is it negotiable, and does it apply uniformly across all transaction types (subscription, managed services, T&M, outcome-based)?

Answer 49:

Refer to RFP Section III. C. - Administrative Fees, for directions on proposing an administrative fee. It is left to the discretion of each proposer to determine and propose an administrative fee that is consistent with its business and its industry.

Question 50:

Can we propose multiple pricing models simultaneously for an integrated Lot 3 offering (e.g., T&M for services, subscription/consumption for the platform, outcome-based for specific deliverables), or must we select a single model?

Answer 50:

See Answer 9 above.

Question 51:

How should pass-through third-party and cloud consumption costs (e.g., hyperscaler usage, foundation-model API costs) be represented - at cost, with a fixed markup, or excluded - and do they count toward the Administrative Fee?

Answer 51:

Refer to Answer 2 above.

Question 52:

Is a published catalog or rate card required at submission, or are not-to-exceed (ceiling) rates by role/labor category sufficient for the services portion?

Answer 52:

Refer to Section III. Pricing and Delivery Schedules in the RFP.

Question 53:

Over the 10-year Master Agreement term, how frequently may pricing and rate cards be updated (e.g., annual CPI escalation), and what is the approval process?

Answer 53:

Refer to Answer 13 above.

Question 54:

Are firm-fixed price hold periods required, and for how long must submitted pricing remain firm?

Answer 54:

It is left to the discretion of each proposer to determine and propose the pricing approach that aligns with their business methods and satisfies all the requirements of RFP Section III – Pricing and Delivery Schedules. Proposals are evaluated based on the criteria stated in the RFP.

Question 55:

Are any subcategories considered mandatory versus optional for a Lot 3 award?

Answer 55:

Refer to Answer 11 above.

Question 56:

Which frameworks or standards does Sourcewell expect alignment to (e.g., NIST AI RMF, ISO/IEC 42001, ISO 27001, SOC 2, FedRAMP, StateRAMP, HIPAA, CJIS), and is certification required or is documented alignment sufficient?

Answer 56:

Refer to Answer 3 above.

Question 57:

For data sovereignty, do Participating Entities require U.S.-only (or Canada-only) data residency and no foreign-subprocessor access by default, or is this defined per entity?

Answer 57:

Sourcwell can contract with a US, Canada or foreign supplier. It is left to the discretion of each proposer to demonstrate how they will effectively deliver the requested goods and services offered in their proposal to participating entities. Each proposal will be evaluated based on the criteria stated in the RFP.

Question 58:

Are on-prem, private-cloud, or air-gapped deployment options expected to be available, or is public cloud acceptable for most Participating Entities?

Answer 58:

Refer to Answer 3 above.

Question 59:

Regarding model training, is an opt-out by default expected for Participating Entity data, and are there constraints on using foundation models that may train on inputs?

Answer 59:

Refer to Answer 3 above.

Question 60:

Will Sourcwell provide the Master Agreement template and Participating Entity terms in advance so we can prepare exceptions/redlines, and how are exceptions scored (neutral versus penalized)?

Answer 60:

Sourcwell's Master Agreement is available in the "Documents" section of the "Bid Details" page on the Sourcwell Procurement Portal. To identify any exception, or to request any modification, to Sourcwell's standard terms, conditions, or specifications, a proposer must submit the proposed exception(s) or requested modification(s) via redline in the Master Agreement uploaded as part of its response. Only those exceptions noted at the time of the proposal submission will be considered.

Question 61:

Are there mandatory federal flow-down clauses, security requirements (e.g., FAR/DFARS, CJIS, HIPAA BAA), or insurance, bonding, and cyber-liability thresholds we must commit to?

Answer 61:

Refer to the Master Agreement available on the Sourcewell Procurement Portal.

Question 62:

What data breach and AI-incident notification timelines do Sourcewell or Participating Entities require, and must these be reflected in our SLAs?

Answer 62:

Refer to Answer 3 above.

Question 62:

Is subcontracting subject to Sourcewell approval, and are there subcontracting or diversity-participation goals that are scored?

Answer 62:

Refer to RFP Section II. D. Single Primary Lot, "... If proposer includes the equipment, products, and services of its subsidiary entities, the proposer must also identify all subsidiaries included in its proposal. If proposer requires the use of distributors, dealers, resellers, or subcontractors to provide the equipment, products, or services, the proposal must address how the equipment, products or services will be provided to Participating Entities, and describe the network of distributors, dealers, resellers, and/or subcontractors that will be available to serve Participating Entities under a resulting master agreement."

It is left to the discretion of each proposer to determine the information or documentation necessary to best demonstrate their ability to serve Sourcewell Participating Entities and satisfy all the requirements of the RFP and the questionnaire tables. Proposals are evaluated based on the criteria stated in the RFP.

Question 63:

Please confirm the Master Agreement term (10 years) and proposal validity (150 days), and whether termination-for-convenience or renewal provisions apply that we should plan pricing around.

Answer 63:

Refer to RFP Section II: C. Rolling Supplier Onboarding and F. Prospective Master Agreement Term.

Question 64:

Do participating entities have materially different platform requirements across segments (federal, local government, K-12, higher ed, healthcare)? Or is a horizontal platform expected to serve all equally?

Answer 65:

Refer to Answer 3 above.

End of Addendum

Acknowledgement of this Addendum to RFP 061726 posted to the Sourcewell Procurement Portal on 6/1/2026, is required at the time of proposal submittal.

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